Transforming Marketing Education with Curriculum-Wide AI Integration

One discipline, every level: AI built into the marketing curriculum, from research methods to the capstone to an AI-in-Marketing course, with local businesses as clients.

Yufan (Frank) Lin · College of Business Administration, Cal Poly Pomona | AI FAST · California Education Learning Lab, Agreement 10664

POSTER 13

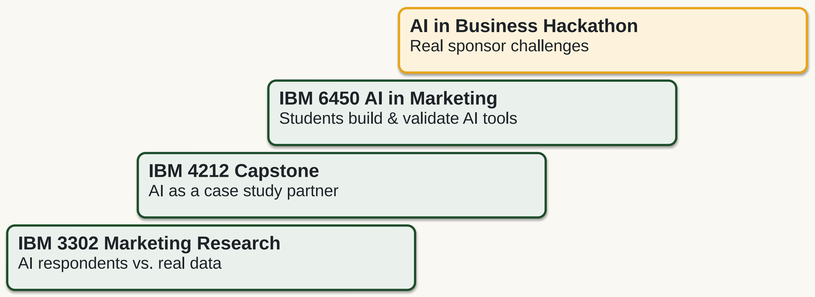
Try it live

Beat the AI ▸ demo table

ODI chatbot · CALIPER · focus group

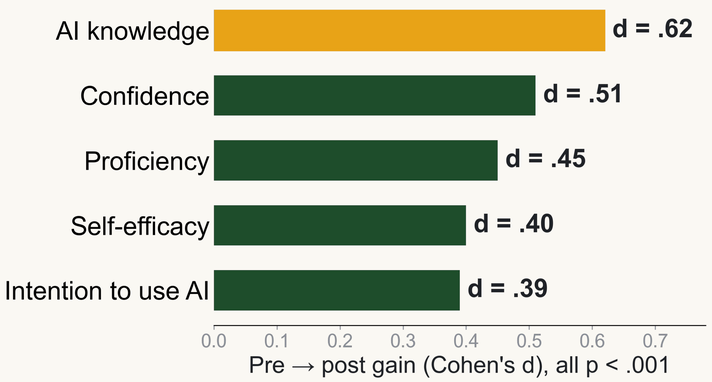
1 One discipline, every level

AI FAST built four plug-and-play modules (Foundations, Ethics, Strategy, Analytics) plus a capstone project, and faculty embedded them in courses they already teach.



1,583	413	20	40
students surveyed	matched pre/post	faculty adopters	course sections

Students gained on every AI self-assessment



Equity: first-generation students gained the most self-efficacy (+0.65 vs. +0.35 for peers). Gains were equal across racial and ethnic groups (39.7% of matched students are Hispanic/Latino).

Honest note: the objective AI-literacy quiz did not move (d = 0.04). Next we assess skills, not only self-reports.

2 Featured modules

A · ODI Grips support chatbot IBM 6450 · IBM 4212

Harvard Business School case 626021 (2025): Bojinov, Cook, Lin, Chen, Kang & Stein. Client: ODI Grips, Riverside, CA (2025 MSDM capstone).

A business bot = four prompt blocks

- **Task** an ODI grip expert
- **Customer persona** racer or recreational rider
- **Tone** like a friendly service rep
- **Data access** the product catalog

Ablation: delete one block, clear the chat, re-run the tests.

Design tests the bot can fail

"I want the Rogue in green."
With the catalog it says no: the Rogue comes only in black, blue, grey and red. Without it, the bot may invent a green one.

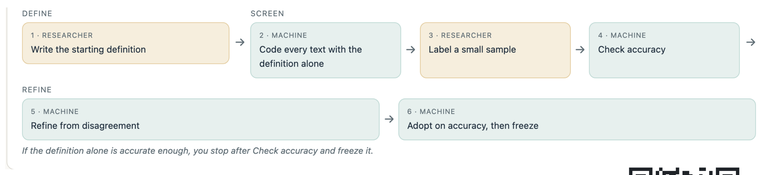
"I want the latest technology."
With the catalog: the Vanquish. Without it: older grips only, past the training cutoff.

Try the bot

▸ Can you make the bot invent a product? Try it at the table

B · CALIPER: build an AI text classifier IBM 6450

Students write a definition and label ~30 examples. Two AI coders and a judge turn their disagreements into written rules; the codebook is adopted only if it beats the plain definition.



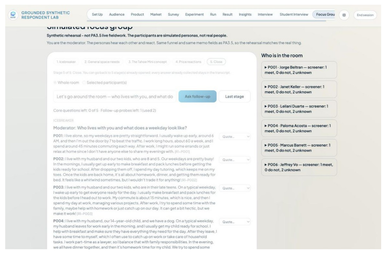
.573 → .809

mean F1 after refinement, on 395 airline chat turns (out-of-fold check built in)

Keyless demo

C · Simulated focus group IBM 3302

Co-designed with Dr. Fan Wang and student developers Anderson Edmond, Minh Nhat Doan and Yaza M. Tun



Students rehearse moderating with 30 personas, then run a real focus group.

"Simulated data writes the first draft; real people get the final word."

Checked against a real n = 600 panel, AI respondents were too uniform: they missed the enthusiasts (8% top-2 box vs. 23% of people) and never said "not for me" (16% of people did).

Try it

3 Local businesses as clients

Students apply AI to real business problems with community partners, then compare AI output with real data.

Course module → Client brief → AI vs. real data → Recommend

Course client
Neo Smart Living (Tahoe Mini backyard unit) and aytm, which donated a national panel of n = 600

Hackathon sponsors
Avanade · ISACA Orange County · Insights Association West · Neo Smart Living & aytm

Capstone clients
ODI Grips (Riverside) · Dough Zone

2026 AI in Business Hackathon

320	50	64
students	teams	judges & mentors

AI-literacy self-rating rose pre → post (d = 0.33, p = .006, n = 73 matched).

At the demo table (2 minutes each)

1 **Beat the AI:** place three coffee brands, then flip to see where AI-simulated consumers and real students put them (IBM 6450 perceptual-map lesson).
2 **ODI chatbot:** watch the bot pass, then fail, a hallucination test.
3 **CALIPER:** watch an AI classifier get built, checked and frozen.
4 **Focus group:** moderate a room of AI personas.

Take it with you

All modules, rubrics, prompts and apps are free to adapt.
Scan the adoption kit: every app to try, the modules, and class recordings in one place. Or browse the live AI in Marketing course hub.

Adoption kit

Course hub

Acknowledgments California Education Learning Lab (AI FAST, Agreement 10664). AI FAST team: Yiwen Chen (SFSU), In-Hye Kang, Randy Stein, Fan Wang; the AI FAST faculty cohort at Cal Poly Pomona and San Francisco State; Tarkington Business Futures Institute; and our student developers and business partners.

yufanlin@cpp.edu
Cal Poly Pomona